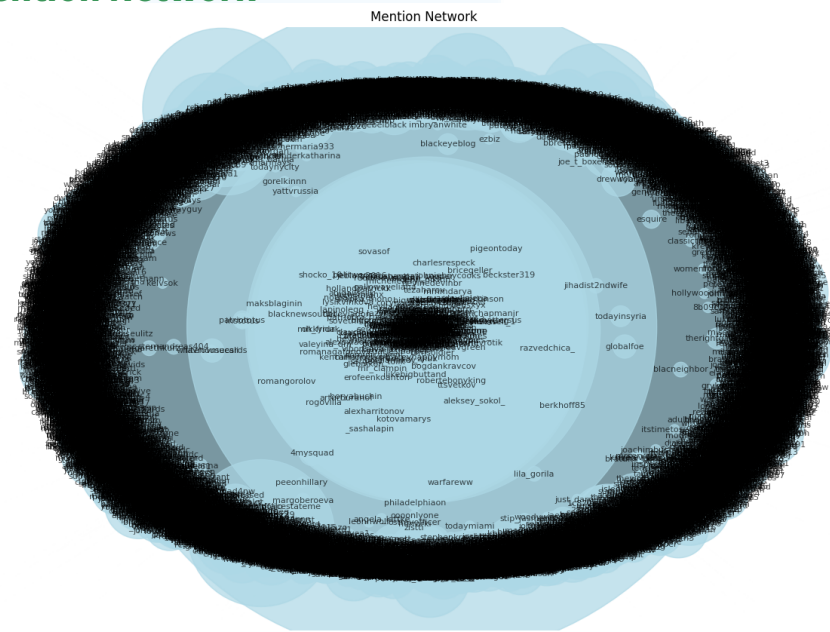


Coordinated political influence detected via network analysis

Bartosz Maj

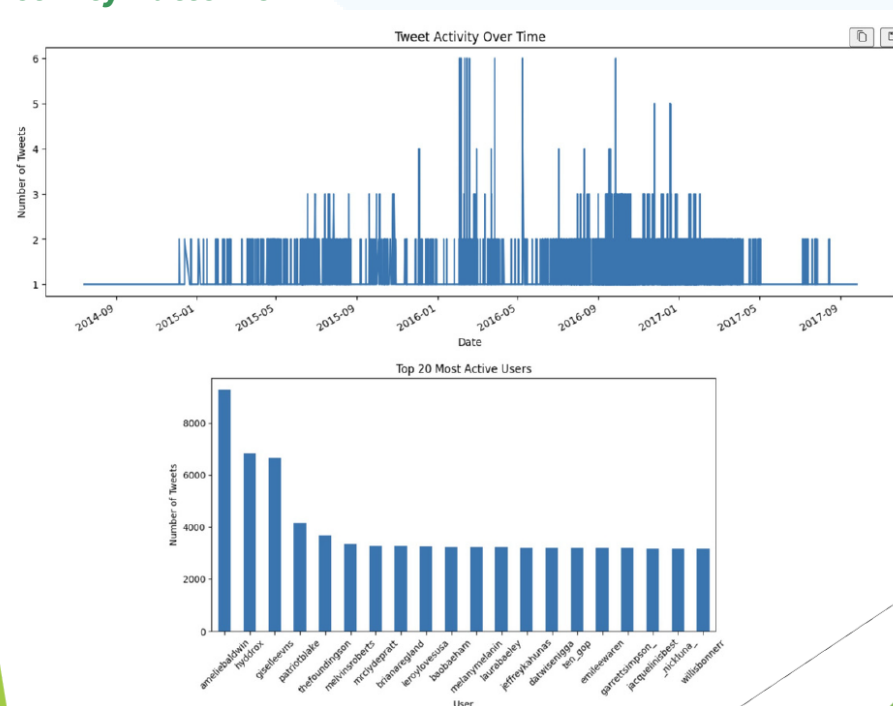
Mention Network



Insight:

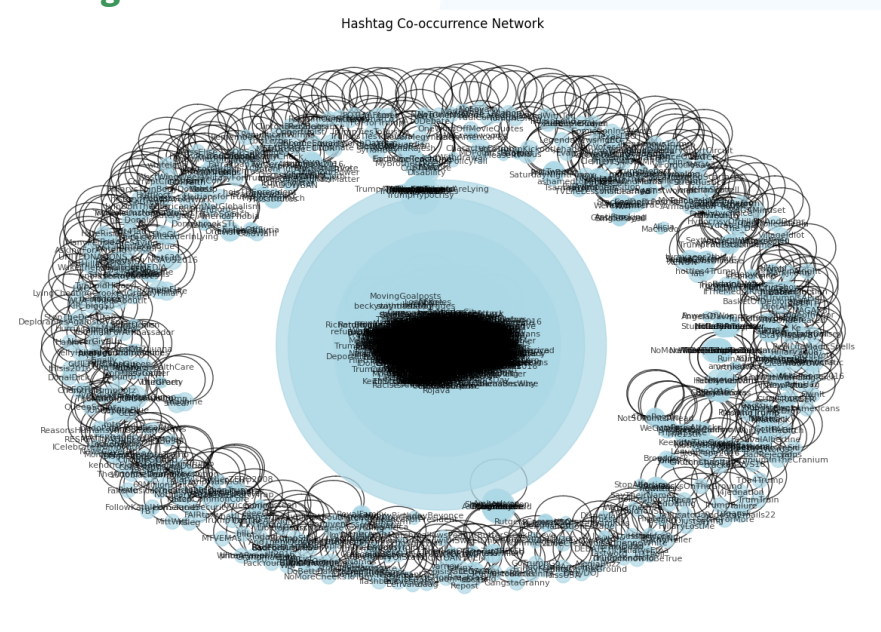
Communication is controlled by a small, highly central core, indicating organized interaction rather than organic discussion.

Activity Patterns

**Insight:**

A small subset of users generates a disproportionate share of all content — a classic coordination signal.

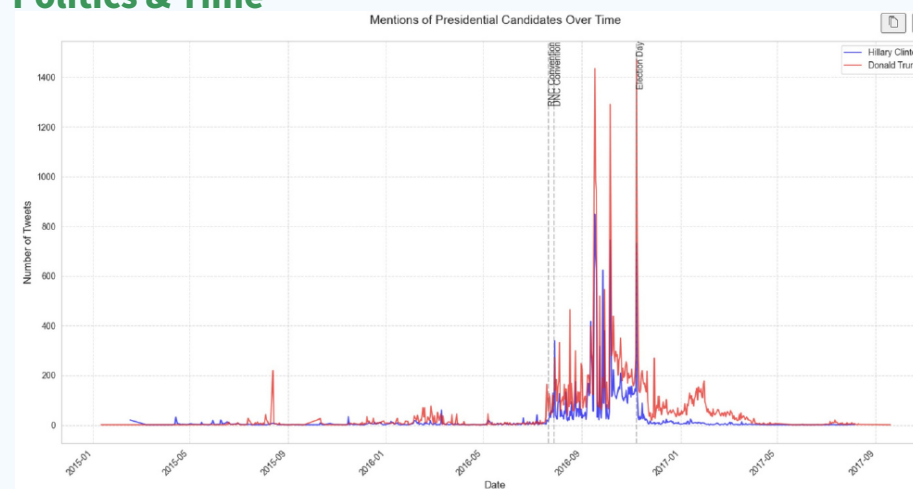
Hashtag Network



Insight:

Hashtags cluster tightly around political narratives, suggesting coordinated framing and message alignment.

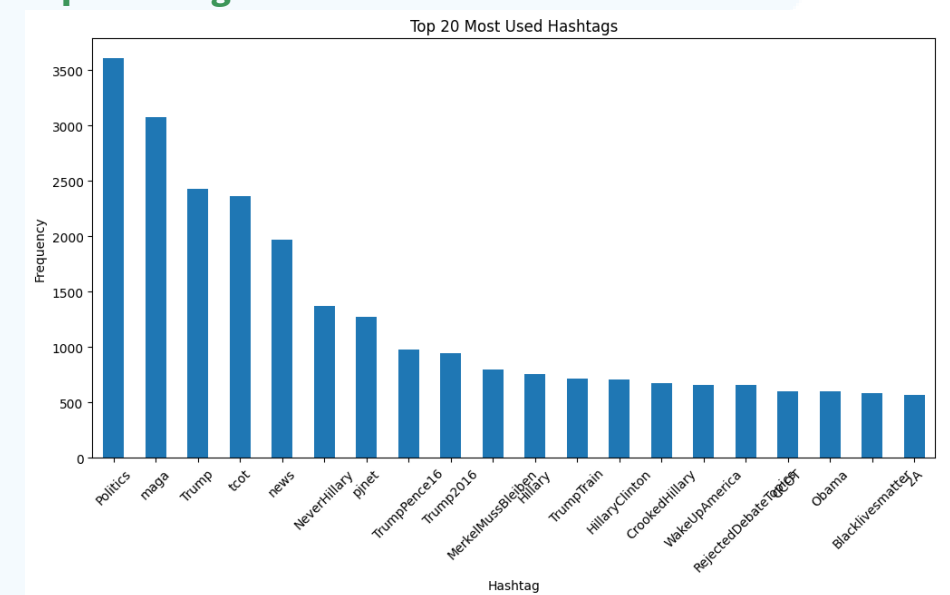
Politics & Time



Insight:

Posting activity peaks align closely with major political events, especially the 2016 US election.

Top Hashtags



Insight:

Systematic hashtag reuse amplifies visibility and artificially boosts topic salience.

Key Findings

- Strongly centralized interaction networks
- Temporal synchronization of activity
- Coordinated narrative amplification

How to Detect Trolls?

- Unusually high posting frequency
- Extreme network centrality (mentions / retweets)
- Repetitive or near-duplicate content
- Synchronized activity across accounts
- Consistent reuse of political hashtags

Strategic Context

What are Russian trolls doing on Twitter?

Russian troll activity is not focused on persuading individual users. Instead, it aims to **manipulate visibility and attention** by exploiting platform dynamics such as engagement, repetition, and timing.

By coordinating many accounts to post similar content, reuse the same hashtags, and act simultaneously during political events, trolls create the impression of widespread public support or controversy.